

8.6 Joomla

8.6.1 Introduction

A relatively new CMS, Joomla has taken the CMS industry by storm. Based on Mambo, it is elegant and extremely easy to use.

It is classified as open source software and is licensed under the terms of the GPL. It can be downloaded free of cost from joomla.org, and the current version is 1.0.8. According to the developers, Joomla 2.0.0 will be completely re-written with PHP5.

Joomla came into existence as a result of a dispute between the developers of Mambo. Miro Corporation, which held the trademark for the name Mambo, came together with a bulk of the core developers to form Joomla. They registered a non-profit organisation to fund the project and to protect it from lawsuits.

Joomla is the phonetic spelling of the Swahili word Jumla, which means “together.”

8.6.2 Features

Being largely based on Mambo, Joomla has a similar set of features. However, it stands out due to certain key features:

- Like Mambo, Joomla looks like just another HTML site. So, the customisation required for Joomla is limited.
- The news and article management system is the *most* advanced, with a fully-featured WYSIWYG editor integrated with options to add tables, flash content and advanced HTML content.
- There is an option to add Metadata to each news story, which is a very useful option and helps in enhancing search engine rankings.
- Joomla features an advanced caching system that helps in improving performance on busy sites.
- An RSS management system is built into Joomla, and you can use it to provide news feeds from your site.
- The Theme Engine is a wonderful addition—a lot of elegant themes are available.